

ReadWise

Evidence-backed one-page app summary

What It Is

ReadWise is a Django web app for book discovery and recommendations. Repo docs and source show two recommendation paths: mood-based suggestions from sentiment analysis and deterministic dataset-based recommendations, plus search and category browsing.

Who It's For

Primary user: readers who want help finding books that match their current mood or interests.

What It Does

- Mood-based recommendations from free-text mood input, with optional "improve mood" behavior.
- Deterministic dataset recommender API backed by JSON datasets and inferred mood profiles.
- Book search across the local catalog with Google Books fallback results.
- Category and trending pages that merge cached local data with external book/category feeds.
- Book detail pages that resolve from the local database first, then Google Books by volume ID.
- User auth flows for signup, login/logout, Google OAuth, profile edit, and password change.
- REST API endpoints for categories, category books, and recommendation requests.

How It Works

- **Web layer:** ``readwise/urls.py`` routes all traffic into ``accounts.urls``; ``accounts/views.py`` serves templates and DRF API views.
- **Core data:** ``accounts/models.py`` stores books, authors, genres, and categories; local dev uses SQLite, while ``DATABASE_URL`` switches production to PostgreSQL.
- **Recommendation services:** ``accounts/services/mood_recommender.py``, ``dataset_recommender.py``, and sentiment modules score books from mood text and dataset metadata.
- **External services:** ``google_books.py`` calls Google Books; ``external.py`` pulls category/book feeds from Google Books and Open Library.
- **Data flow:** browser/API request -> Django view/API -> local DB and/or service module -> optional cache/external fetch -> normalized book cards or JSON response -> template/API output.

How To Run

- Create and activate a virtual environment: ``python -m venv venv`` then ``venv\Scripts\activate`` on Windows.
- Install dependencies: ``pip install -r requirements.txt``.
- Create ``.env`` from ``.env.example``; required values shown there include ``SECRET_KEY``, ``DEBUG``, Google OAuth keys, and ``DATABASE_URL``.
- Run migrations: ``python manage.py migrate``.
- Start the app: ``python manage.py runserver``.

Not found in repo: no explicit product owner, target organization, or formal system diagram.